

Japan Technology: IT Services: Accenture results read-across: Consensus beat; structural expansion in AI investment; AI benefits emerging

IT services major Accenture (Buy, covered by US Telecom/IT Services analyst James Schneider) announced 4Q (June–August) and full-year FY8/26 results at 20:00 JST (07:00 US local time) on October 1, followed by a conference call at 21:00 JST. **4Q sales beat the Bloomberg consensus and growth (yoy) accelerated, while order growth turned positive. By region, sales growth accelerated in the Americas and Europe, while Japan and Australia continued to drive growth in Asia. According to the company, negative effects from the Middle East situation are ongoing, but demand for AI-driven business transformation, including for core systems, data, and infrastructure, is expanding structurally, and this trend is expected to continue. Benefits from AI are now emerging that outweigh the impact of AI disruption.**

Chikai Tanaka, CFA
+81(3)4587-9840 |
chikai.tanaka@gs.com
Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd.

Yuki Sato
+81(3)4587-8536 | yuki.z.sato@gs.com
Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd.

In terms of read-across for the Japanese IT services sector, we see these results as somewhat positive for earnings at NTT (Buy), given its subsidiary NTT Data's high overseas sales exposure (FY3/26 overseas sales ratio: 60%). Meanwhile, AI-related business is also starting to expand in Japan, and we view NEC, Fujitsu, Nomura Research Institute (NRI), and BayCurrent (all Buy rated) as well-placed to benefit. Below, we outline our key takeaways from the conference call (growth rates are all on a local-currency (LC) basis).

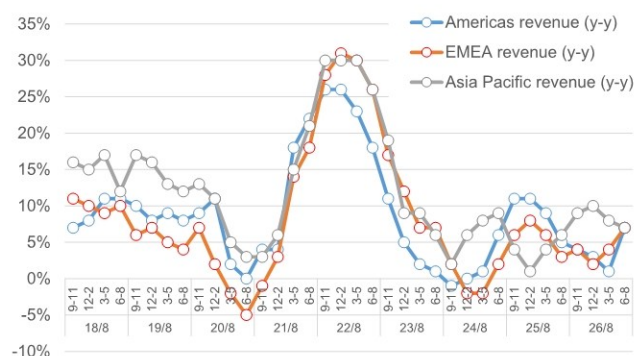
- **4Q8/26 earnings:** 4Q8/26 sales of US\$18.68 bn (+7% yoy; 3Q growth was +3% yoy), came in above the top end of the guidance range (+1% to +5% yoy) and beat the Bloomberg consensus (US\$18.04 bn), with growth accelerating. By region, sales growth was +7% yoy in the Americas (3Q: +1% yoy), +7% in EMEA (+4%), and +7% in Asia (+8%), marking accelerated growth in the Americas and Europe, and further stable growth in Asia ([Exhibit 1](#)). In the Americas, the impact of US government investment curbs have run its course, leading to an improvement centered around AI-related business. There was a pick-up in EMEA, driven mainly by the UK and Italy, while Japan, Australia, and Singapore continued to drive growth in Asia. By client industry, communications, media, and technology (+11% yoy) remained robust, while healthcare & public services (+9% yoy) recovered from a roughly flat yoy trend over the past year, amid struggles mainly in the US government sector. Operating profits totaled US\$2.86 bn (+40% yoy / adjusted OP +7% yoy; OPM +0.2 pp yoy), beating the Bloomberg consensus of US\$2.74 bn ([Exhibit 2](#)). Meanwhile, headcount increased +2.0% qoq, and the attrition rate was 13% (-2 pp yoy / -1 pp qoq; [Exhibit 3](#)).

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- **Order environment:** Turning to orders, 4Q new bookings turned to positive growth of +4% yoy (LC basis; 3Q: -3% yoy; Exhibit 4). By service type, consulting orders, a leading indicator for system integration and development demand, grew +6% yoy (USD basis, no disclosure on LC basis), while managed services orders were up +3% yoy, both marking moderate growth. Although negative impacts from the Middle East situation persist, corporate appetite for AI investment remains strong, driving growing demand for various systems and data infrastructure in conjunction with AI deployment.
- **Guidance:** FY8/27 sales guidance (LC) is for +3% to +6% yoy, and 1Q sales guidance is for US\$18.95 bn to US\$19.6 bn (+2% to +6% yoy). The midpoint of the full-year guidance range is slightly above the Bloomberg consensus, while the midpoint of the 1Q guidance range was broadly in line with the Bloomberg consensus. According to Accenture, (1) while headwinds from the Middle East situation will likely persist, restrained investment by the US government, which has dragged on performance, appears to have run its course and is expected to recover; (2) discretionary spending is expected to show slight improvement; and (3) demand for AI-driven business transformation, including core systems, data, and infrastructure platforms, should remain structurally strong.

Exhibit 1: Growth recovers in the Americas and Europe, while Asia remains solid

Accenture sales by region (local-currency basis)

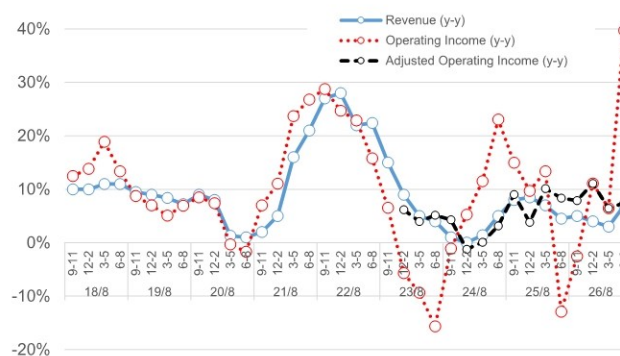


Regional definitions changed in 1Q8/24, reclassifying Latin America sales from Growth to North America, and with this North America was changed to Americas, while Growth was changed to Asia Pacific; EMEA unchanged.

Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Both sales and profit (adjusted basis) growth rates accelerate somewhat

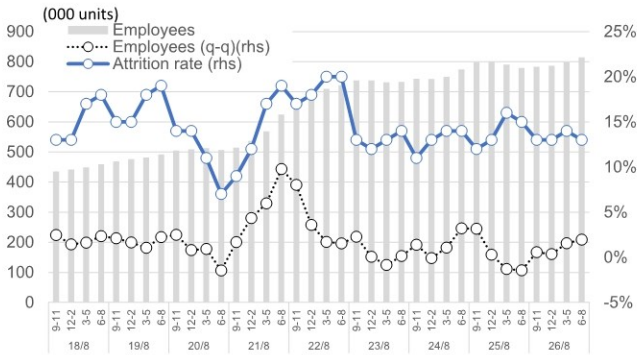
Accenture sales (local-currency basis) and operating profits/adjusted operating profits



Adjusted operating profits = operating profits + business optimization costs.

Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Headcount continues to rise qoq
Accenture headcount and attrition rate



Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: 4Q orders turn to positive growth of +4% yoy
Accenture orders (USD basis)



Exhibit 5: 4Q8/26 sales and operating profits both beat consensus, orders growth turns positive

Accenture: Earnings statement

Accenture (ACN)(mn \$)	24/8				25/8				26/8			
	9-11	12-2	3-5	6-8	9-11	12-2	3-5	6-8	9-11	12-2	3-5	6-8
New Bookings	18,450	21,580	21,060	20,150	18,700	20,910	19,700	21,310	20,940	22,110	19,320	22,170
(y-y)	13.7%	-2.3%	22.1%	21.1%	1.4%	-3.1%	-6.5%	5.8%	12.0%	5.7%	-1.9%	4.0%
(y-y: LC)	12.0%	-2.0%	26.0%	24.0%	1.0%	0.0%	-7.0%	3.0%	10.0%	1.0%	-3.0%	4.0%
(BB ratio)	1.14	1.37	1.28	1.23	1.06	1.26	1.11	1.21	1.10	1.20	1.00	1.20
Consulting	8,620	10,520	9,280	8,590	9,220	10,470	9,080	8,870	9,880	11,330	10,260	9,400
(y-y)	6.3%	-1.2%	3.9%	1.4%	7.0%	-0.5%	-2.2%	3.3%	7.2%	8.2%	13.0%	6.0%
(BB ratio)	1.02	1.31	1.10	1.04	1.02	1.26	1.01	1.01	1.05	1.28	1.10	1.00
Managed Services	9,830	11,060	11,780	11,550	9,480	10,440	10,620	12,440	11,060	10,780	9,060	12,770
(y-y)	21.2%	-3.2%	41.6%	41.4%	-3.6%	-5.6%	-9.8%	7.7%	16.7%	3.3%	-14.7%	2.7%
(BB ratio)	1.27	1.42	1.47	1.42	1.10	1.25	1.22	1.41	1.19	1.17	0.96	1.40
P/L												
Revenues	16,224	15,800	16,467	16,406	17,690	16,659	17,728	17,596	18,742	18,044	18,718	18,679
(y-y)	3.0%	-0.1%	-0.6%	2.6%	9.0%	5.4%	7.7%	7.3%	6.0%	8.3%	5.6%	6.2%
(y-y: LC)	1.0%	0.0%	1.4%	5.0%	8.0%	8.5%	7.0%	4.5%	5.0%	4.0%	3.0%	7.0%
Operating Income	2,565	2,046	2,631	2,354	2,948	2,245	2,983	2,050	2,874	2,494	3,175	2,863
(y-y)	-1.1%	5.2%	11.5%	23.0%	15.0%	9.7%	13.4%	-12.9%	-2.5%	11.1%	6.5%	39.7%
(OPM)	15.8%	13.0%	16.0%	14.3%	16.7%	13.5%	16.8%	11.6%	15.3%	13.8%	17.0%	15.3%
Business Optimization Cost (SGA)	140	115	77	106				615	308			
Americas	50	12	-4	25				420	67			
EMEA	71	86	75	17				132	170			
Asia Pacific	19	18	6	64				63	71			
Adjusted Operating Income	2,705	2,162	2,708	2,460	2,948	2,245	2,983	2,665	3,181	2,494	3,175	2,863
(y-y)	4.3%	-1.2%	0.1%	3.1%	9.0%	3.8%	10.1%	8.4%	7.9%	11.1%	6.4%	7.4%
(OPM)	16.7%	13.7%	16.4%	15.0%	16.7%	13.5%	16.8%	15.1%	17.0%	13.8%	17.0%	15.3%
Revenues & Operating Income by Geographic Markets												
<Revenues>												
Americas	8,027	7,816	8,287	8,423	8,733	8,553	8,966	8,804	9,080	8,896	9,138	9,432
(y-y)	-	-	-	-	8.8%	9.4%	8.2%	4.5%	4.0%	4.0%	1.9%	7.1%
(y-y: LC)	-	-	-	-	11.0%	11.0%	9.0%	5.0%	4.0%	3.0%	1.0%	7.0%
(% of sales)	49.5%	49.5%	50.3%	51.3%	49.4%	51.3%	50.6%	50.0%	48.4%	49.3%	48.8%	50.5%
EMEA	5,804	5,599	5,777	5,639	6,412	5,804	6,232	6,196	6,935	6,569	6,873	6,581
(y-y)	9.2%	0.8%	-1.6%	1.5%	10.5%	3.7%	7.9%	9.9%	8.2%	13.2%	10.3%	6.2%
(y-y: LC)	2.0%	-2.0%	-2.0%	2.0%	6.0%	8.0%	6.0%	3.0%	4.0%	2.0%	4.0%	7.0%
(% of sales)	35.8%	35.4%	35.1%	34.4%	36.2%	34.8%	35.2%	35.2%	37.0%	36.4%	36.7%	35.2%
Asia Pacific	2,394	2,385	2,404	2,344	2,544	2,302	2,530	2,596	2,727	2,578	2,707	2,666
(y-y)	-	-	-	-	6.3%	-3.5%	5.2%	10.7%	7.2%	12.0%	7.0%	2.7%
(y-y: LC)	-	-	-	-	4.0%	1.0%	4.0%	6.0%	9.0%	10.0%	8.0%	7.0%
(% of sales)	14.8%	15.1%	14.6%	14.3%	14.4%	13.8%	14.3%	14.8%	14.6%	14.3%	14.5%	14.3%
<Operating Income>												
Americas	1,293	1,083	1,408	1,296	1,377	1,240	1,720	987	1,527	1,393	1,708	1,616
(y-y)	-	-	-	-	6.5%	14.5%	22.2%	-23.8%	10.9%	12.3%	-0.7%	63.7%
(OPM)	16.1%	13.9%	17.0%	15.4%	15.8%	14.5%	19.2%	11.2%	16.8%	15.7%	18.7%	17.1%
EMEA	824	529	750	701	1,036	639	753	663	900	677	994	865
(y-y)	13.3%	-14.0%	11.9%	48.9%	25.8%	20.8%	0.4%	-5.5%	-13.1%	5.9%	32.0%	30.6%
(OPM)	14.2%	9.4%	13.0%	12.4%	16.2%	11.0%	12.1%	10.7%	13.0%	10.3%	14.5%	13.1%
Asia Pacific	448	434	473	357	535	365	510	400	446	424	473	382
(y-y)	-	-	-	-	19.4%	-15.9%	7.8%	12.1%	-16.7%	16.1%	-7.2%	-4.4%
(OPM)	18.7%	18.2%	19.7%	15.2%	21.0%	15.9%	20.2%	15.4%	16.4%	16.4%	17.5%	14.3%
Revenues by Industry Groups												
Comm. Media & Tech	2,669	2,654	2,763	2,751	2,858	2,730	2,912	2,954	3,102	3,091	3,218	3,262
(y-y)	-10.4%	-8.0%	-4.1%	1.6%	7.1%	2.8%	5.4%	7.4%	8.5%	13.2%	10.5%	10.4%
(y-y: LC)	-11.0%	-7.0%	-1.0%	5.0%	7.0%	6.0%	5.0%	5.0%	8.0%	10.0%	9.0%	11.0%
(% of sales)	16.5%	16.8%	16.8%	16.8%	16.2%	16.4%	16.4%	16.8%	16.6%	17.1%	17.2%	17.5%
Financial Services	3,034	2,809	2,895	2,873	3,169	3,010	3,279	3,316	3,602	3,395	3,489	3,473
(y-y)	2.4%	-6.5%	-7.8%	-5.1%	4.5%	7.2%	13.3%	15.4%	13.7%	12.8%	6.4%	4.7%
(y-y: LC)	0.0%	-6.0%	-5.0%	-2.0%	4.0%	11.0%	13.0%	12.0%	12.0%	7.0%	3.0%	6.0%
(% of sales)	18.7%	17.8%	17.6%	17.5%	17.9%	18.1%	18.5%	18.8%	19.2%	18.8%	18.6%	18.6%
Health & Public Service	3,377	3,334	3,515	3,614	3,813	3,609	3,778	3,564	3,797	3,670	3,845	3,859
(y-y)	12.6%	10.3%	7.6%	10.5%	12.9%	8.2%	7.5%	-1.4%	-0.4%	1.7%	1.8%	8.3%
(y-y: LC)	12.0%	10.0%	9.0%	11.0%	12.0%	10.0%	7.0%	-3.0%	-1.0%	-1.0%	0.0%	9.0%
(% of sales)	20.8%	21.1%	21.3%	22.0%	21.6%	21.7%	21.3%	20.3%	20.3%	20.3%	20.5%	20.7%
Products	4,860	4,762	4,983	4,949	5,425	5,052	5,344	5,376	5,741	5,477	5,669	5,564
(y-y)	8.5%	0.9%	0.3%	4.2%	11.6%	6.1%	7.2%	8.6%	5.8%	8.4%	6.1%	3.5%
(y-y: LC)	1.0%	0.0%	2.0%	6.0%	10.0%	9.0%	7.0%	5.0%	4.0%	3.0%	3.0%	4.0%
(% of sales)	30.0%	30.1%	30.3%	30.2%	30.7%	30.3%	30.1%	30.6%	30.6%	30.4%	30.3%	29.8%
Resources	2,284	2,241	2,310	2,220	2,425	2,258	2,415	2,387	2,499	2,411	2,498	2,521
(y-y)	6.8%	2.6%	-0.1%	-0.4%	6.2%	0.8%	4.5%	7.5%	3.1%	6.8%	3.4%	5.6%
(y-y: LC)	6.0%	4.0%	3.0%	3.0%	6.0%	5.0%	4.0%	5.0%	2.0%	2.0%	1.0%	6.0%
(% of sales)	14.1%	14.2%	14.0%	13.5%	13.7%	13.6%	13.6%	13.6%	13.3%	13.4%	13.3%	13.5%
Revenues by Type of Work												
Consulting	8,457	8,021	8,457	8,260	9,045	8,282	9,007	8,772	9,415	8,860	9,328	9,281
(y-y)	0.1%	-3.1%	-2.7%	0.8%	7.0%	3.3%	6.5%	6.2%	4.1%	7.0%	3.6%	5.8%
(y-y: LC)	-2.0%	-3.0%	-1.0%	3.0%	6.0%	6.0%	6.0%	3.0%	3.0%	3.0%	1.0%	7.0%
(% of sales)	52.1%	50.8%	51.4%	50.4%	51.1%	49.7%	50.8%	49.9%	50.2%	49.1%	49.8%	49.7%
Managed Services	7,768	7,778	8,010	8,145	8,644	8,377	8,721	8,824	9,328	9,184	9,390	9,398
(y-y)	6.4%	3.2%	1.8%	4.6%	11.3%	7.7%	8.9%	8.3%	7.9%	9.6%	7.7%	6.5%
(y-y: LC)	5.0%	3.0%	4.0%	7.0%	11.0%	11.0%	9.0%	6.0%	7.0%	5.0%	5.0%	7.0%
(% of sales)	47.9%	49.2%	48.6%	49.6%	48.9%	50.3%	49.2%	50.1%	49.8%	50.9%	50.2%	50.3%

LC denotes local currency basis; regional definitions changed in 1Q8/25, reclassifying Latin America sales from Growth to North America, and with this North America was changed to Americas, while Growth was changed to Asia Pacific; EMEA unchanged.

Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

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We, Chikai Tanaka, CFA and Yuki Sato, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Contributing Authors: Chikai Tanaka, CFA Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd., Yuki Sato Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd..

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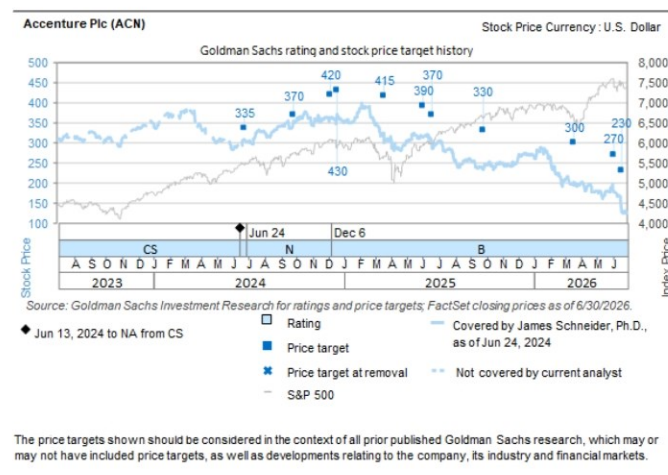
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

Accenture Plc (ACN)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
01-Oct-26	260.00	183.37
18-Jun-26	230.00	127.98
03-Jun-26	270.00	177.43
19-Mar-26	300.00	203.55
25-Sep-25	330.00	232.56
20-Jun-25	370.00	285.37
03-Jun-25	390.00	312.90
20-Mar-25	415.00	300.91
19-Dec-24	430.00	372.16
06-Dec-24	420.00	362.70
26-Sep-24	370.00	355.81
24-Jun-24	335.00	307.21

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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